

# Chicago Tribune



QUESTIONS? CALL 1-800-TRIBUNE

WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 14, 2026

BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

## Trial opens in case of slain judge

Prosecutors say Earl Wilson and another man killed Raymond Myles in an attempted robbery

By Madeline Buckley  
Chicago Tribune

Before presiding over his courtroom at the Leighton Criminal Court Building each morning, Cook County Associate Judge Raymond Myles was known to rise early and go to the gym. But unbeknownst to him, prosecutors said, someone was watching him, studying his movements over the course of several days as he and his girlfriend left to work out in the morning before work. Then, on April 10, 2017, the long-time jurist was shot and killed in an act of violence that stunned his colleagues at the county’s main Southwest Side courthouse

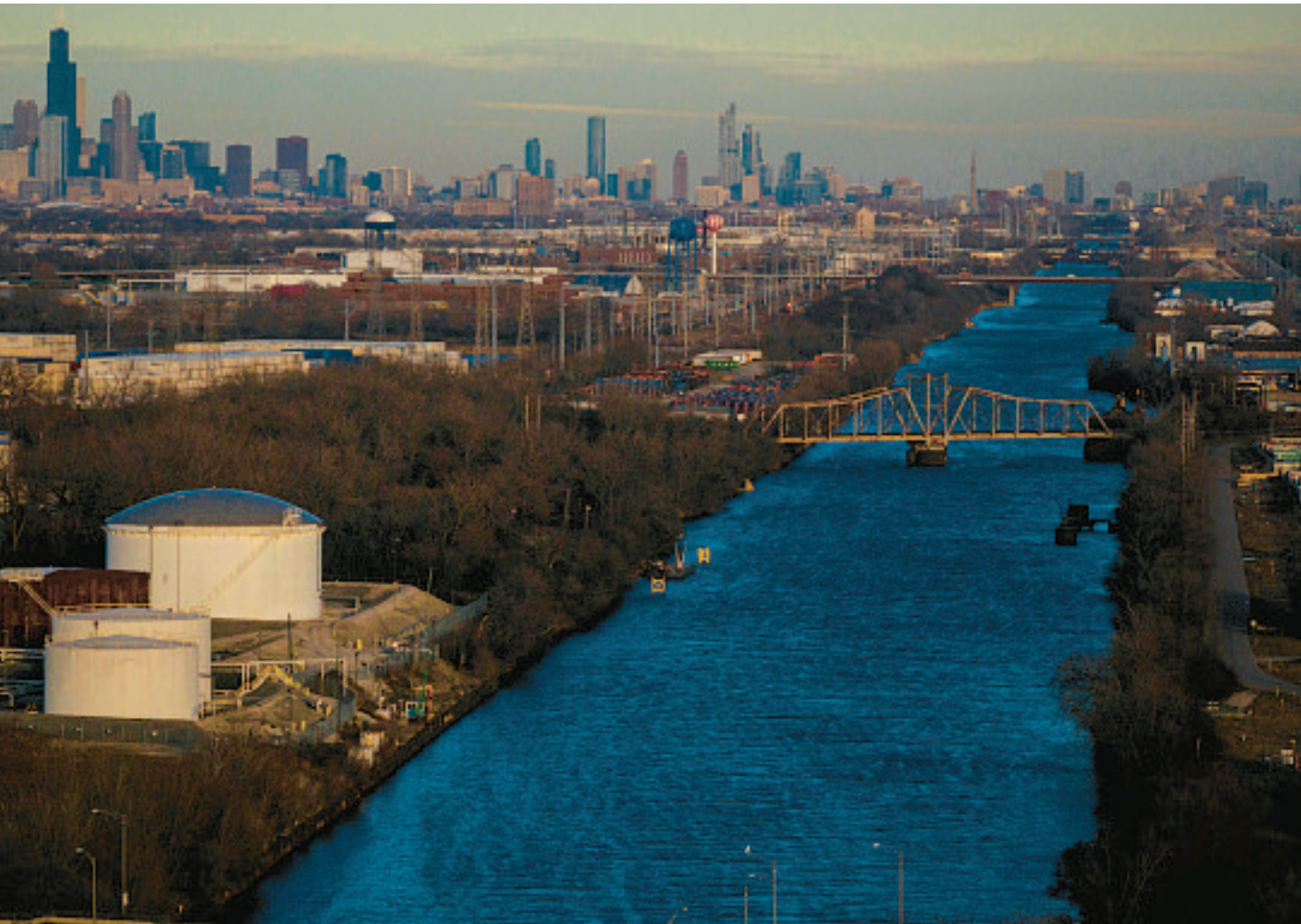
where he for years had presided over cases — many involving acts of violence similar to his own slaying. Myles, 66, was the first Chicago-area judge to be shot and killed in more than three decades in a case that generated national news and a massive police investigation. In 1983, a former Chicago police officer shot and killed Judge Henry A. Gentile, 63, and attorney James Piszczor, 34, in Gentile’s Daley Center courtroom in downtown Chicago. During a trial that opened Tuesday morning at a branch courthouse in south suburban Bridgeview, Cook County prosecutors alleged that Earl Wilson, 54, and another man killed Myles

and injured his girlfriend, in an attempted robbery, believing that the girlfriend had money in her gym bag. Wilson’s co-defendant, Joshua Smith, pleaded guilty in 2024 to armed robbery and was sentenced to 35 years in prison. The trial is overseen by DuPage County Judge Jeffrey MacKay to avoid the perception of bias by Myles’ fellow Cook County judges. It began before a full courtroom of family members and supporters, and is expected to last around two weeks. Wilson is charged with murder, armed robbery and other felonies. “He was watching them and he was waiting and he was seeing what time they came and went,” Assistant State’s Attorney Jennifer Keating said during her opening

Turn to Trial, Page 2



Earl Wilson, left, stands ahead of openings in his jury trial for the 2017 fatal shooting of Cook County Judge Raymond Myles and the shooting of his girlfriend, at the Cook County courthouse in Bridgeview on Tuesday. Assistant Public Defender Takenya Nixon is at center and Assistant Public Defender LaFonzo Palmer is at right. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**



The U.S. EPA's cleanup efforts after a toxic asphalt spill in the Chicago Sanitary and Ship Canal, shown here looking east from Harlem Avenue on Tuesday, have prompted criticism from state and local officials and environmental advocates. **E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

## EPA criticized for unfinished cleanup of toxic asphalt spill

Half-million gallons of sludge poured into Chicago Sanitary and Ship Canal nearly a year ago

By Christiana Freitag  
Chicago Tribune

Nearly a year after a toxic asphalt spill in the Chicago Sanitary and Ship Canal, state and local officials and environmental advocates say the U.S. Environmental Protection Agency ended the cleanup effort before it was completed. A week before Thanksgiving, the agency posted a notice on its website that federal operations in the canal had been concluded. “That was kind of shock-

ing that (the EPA) is not living up to the things that they need to do, protecting the environment and monitoring this,” said Jen Walling, executive director of the Illinois Environmental Council. “It was a half-million gallons of liquid asphalt that was just poured into the river. That’s incredibly problematic.” The thick, tar-like asphalt sludge contains a mixture of harmful carcinogens and heavy metals like lead, mercury and arsenic, making spills toxic to humans and animals.

The U.S. EPA found Petroleum Fuel & Terminal Co. responsible for polluting the waterways in Bedford Park and Forest View but did not issue the company any citations or penalties during its months of oversight. More than 2,000 tons of asphalt were recovered and more than 100 animals rescued and rehabilitated, the costs of which were borne by PF&T, said U.S. EPA spokesperson David Shark. The Illinois Environmental Protection Agency, which is now overseeing the site, observed

asphalt in the canal and along the shoreline after the cleanup was reported complete, said IEPA public information officer Kim Biggs in a statement last week. On Dec. 5, the IEPA sent a notice to PF&T citing it for violating its agreement with the U.S. EPA, Biggs said. The agency is awaiting PF&T’s response to the allegations. PF&T did not respond to repeated requests from the Tribune for comment.

Turn to Spill, Page 2

## Clintons, panel clash over subpoena

Deposition sought in House Oversight’s Epstein case inquiry

By Stephen Groves  
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — Former President Bill Clinton and former Secretary of State Hillary Clinton said Tuesday that they will refuse to comply with a congressional subpoena to testify in a House committee’s investigation of Jeffrey Epstein even as Republican lawmakers prepare contempt of Congress proceedings against them. The Clintons, in a letter released on social media, slammed the House Oversight inquiry as “legally invalid” and wrote that the chair of the House Oversight Committee, Republican Rep. James Comer, is on the cusp of a process “literally designed to result in our imprisonment.” “We will forcefully defend ourselves,” wrote the Clintons, who are Democrats. They accused Comer of allowing other former officials to provide written statements about Epstein to the committee, while selectively enforcing subpoenas against them. The intensifying clash adds another dimension to the fight over Epstein, raising new questions about the limits of congressional power to compel testimony. It also comes when Republicans are grappling with the Justice Department’s delayed release of the Epstein files after a bipartisan push for their release. Comer said he’ll begin contempt of Congress proceedings next week. It potentially starts a complicated and politically messy process that Congress has rarely reached for and could result in prosecution from the Justice Department. “No one’s accusing the Clintons of any wrongdoing. We just have questions,” Comer said after Bill

Turn to Subpoena, Page 10

### INSIDE

‘You can always find ways to get better’



Ayo Dosunmu has always taken an egoless approach to his role and has been a stabilizing force for the Bulls. Is he also one of their best trade assets? **Chicago Sports**

**‘HE GAVE SO MUCH’:** After their patriarch was deported to Pakistan, the family vows to keep beloved Humboldt Park shop Best Sub #2 open. **Food & Health**



Customers use video gaming machines in a room at Crazy Times Pub and Grill in Machesney Park, near the Wisconsin border, on March 26, 2025. **E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

## Chicago’s plan to legalize video gambling in flux

By Jake Sheridan  
Chicago Tribune

Chicago’s new plan to legalize video gambling terminals — finally passed last month as part of the 2026 budget after years of debate — is not a done deal as Mayor Brandon Johnson and key aldermen say negotiations must continue. The ongoing discussions between Johnson’s administration and aldermen over the gambling terminals mark the

first major efforts to amend the budget passed by the City Council against the mayor’s wishes in late December. Top Johnson adviser Jason Lee said the legalization of gambling machines in bars and restaurants across the city “requires more time and some judicious collaboration,” the clearest sign yet that it’s not a settled matter at City Hall. “There are a number of alder-

Turn to Gambling, Page 4

